

The toast plan

The two of us: _____

Date: _____

Prepare, prepare, prepare. Start with who already thinks they are giving one, then give each a number of minutes.

THE TOASTS HAPPEN

☐ before dinner ☐ between courses ☐ after dinner

TOASTS START AT

_____ : _____

THE ORDER one minute of applause and walk-up per speaker is in the count

#	NAME	WHO THEY ARE	MIN	THE ONE LINE THE MC SAYS TO BRING THEM UP	MIC	READY
1					☐ stand ☐ holds	☐ yes ☐ notes
2					☐ stand ☐ holds	☐ yes ☐ notes
3					☐ stand ☐ holds	☐ yes ☐ notes
4					☐ stand ☐ holds	☐ yes ☐ notes
5					☐ stand ☐ holds	☐ yes ☐ notes
6					☐ stand ☐ holds	☐ yes ☐ notes

THE BLESSING, IF ANY: WHO GIVES IT (TWO MINUTES, BEFORE THE MEAL)

WHO HANDS AND TAKES THE MIC (ONE PERSON, EVERY TIME)

the MC

OPEN MIC AT THE END?

☐ no ☐ yes, capped at _____ minutes

SURPRISE TOASTS?

☐ no ☐ yes: names and tables on the back

THE PLANNED BIT, IF ANY: WHO IS IN ON IT, AND THE TWO-LINE SCRIPT

ADD IT UP

speakers' minutes _____ + one per speaker _____ + blessing (2) _____ + open mic cap _____ = _____ **minutes total**

THE RULES I USE

Four minutes each is plenty; past five the room is looking for the exit, past eight you have lost them. Four speakers and fifteen minutes are the most a dinner will forgive. One hand gives the mic and takes it back.

Speaker cards

The two of us: _____

Date: _____

Four to a page, cut along the gaps. Fill one in for each speaker and hand it over the week of the wedding. The card copy is the plan's, not theirs.

TOAST CARD · FOR: _____

speaker's name
_____You are on at about _____, right after
_____.

You have _____ minutes.

_____ hands you the mic and takes it
back.

Speak into it, not around it.

Notes on paper beat notes on a phone.

Thank you, _____

TOAST CARD · FOR: _____

speaker's name
_____You are on at about _____, right after
_____.

You have _____ minutes.

_____ hands you the mic and takes it
back.

Speak into it, not around it.

Notes on paper beat notes on a phone.

Thank you, _____

TOAST CARD · FOR: _____

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Thank you, _____